SEMITRICAL FINDING · MEMORY AND STORAGE

2027 is already sold. Here is what is fixed, what is open, and when you have to decide.

A planning note for CPOs, VPs of Sourcing and Supply Chain
Evidence to 3 November 2026

By their own public statements, the memory makers have already committed most of their 2027 output, and the capacity meant to relieve it does not produce inside 2027. Micron says more than 75% of fiscal 2027 shipments are committed. SK Hynix's long-term agreements cover more than half of 2027–28 capacity. Seagate has priced the entirety of calendar 2027.

No forecast appears on this page. Every line is a dated statement a named company made about its own plans. We publish no view on where prices go; what we can tell you is what is already contracted, which turns out to be the more useful half.

1 · Already fixed for 2027 — so not negotiable, whatever the quote says

SUPPLIER	WHAT IS ALREADY COMMITTED	STATUS
Micron	"More than 75% of fiscal 2027 shipments are already committed", with allocation talks moved out to 2028. Calendar 2027 HBM pricing raised "significantly" and reset at the start of the year. FQ4-26 call, 30 Sep 2026	Locked
SK Hynix	Agreements with **14 key customers**, typically five years, covering **more than 50% of 2027–28 capacity**. Deposits required. 2027 HBM volumes and prices settled. Q3-26 call, 28 Oct 2026	Locked
Samsung	Multi-year contracts are **60–70% of planned capacity**; advance payments are "a contractual requirement". On pre-booked demand alone the 2027 gap is wider than 2026. Q1-26 and Q2-26 calls	Locked
Seagate	Contracts "define both product configuration and pricing terms, covering the entirety of calendar 2027". Nearline is allocated into calendar 2028. Q4-26 call	Locked
Kioxia	Targeting only **50% of shipments under agreement by 2028** — least committed of the five, and 2027 is while that holds. Q1-26 call	Open

What to do with it: arguing 2027 price with a supplier that has already contracted 2027 is arguing against signed paper. The live window at Micron, SK Hynix and Seagate is **2028**; at Kioxia it is now.

2 · When the new capacity actually produces — on the builders' own timelines

DATE	WHO	WHAT THEY SAID, AND WHAT IT MEANS
Through 2027	Lam Research	Clean room space is "the constraining item… through next year for sure"; a new clean room takes **about two years**; about **10 new tier-1 fabs come online during 2027**. Fabs opening is not output shipping. Citi TMT 9 Sep 2026; CQ3-26 call
Mid-2027	Micron	First Idaho wafers, with **meaningful supply a few quarters later**. Tongluo ships from fiscal 2028, and most fiscal 2027 construction spend is for clean rooms online **late 2028 and beyond**. FQ3-26 and FQ4-26 calls
Phased 2027	SK Hynix	Yongin and M17 shells go up early but clean rooms open in phases, and ramp "will be adjusted in line with demand". **The ramp is discretionary, not automatic.** Q3-26 call, 28 Oct 2026
Into 2028	Samsung	Higher 2027 capex **will not lift 2028 bits much**: much of it buys space, construction and tool costs inflate the figure, and tool lead times are longer. Q3-26 call, 29 Oct 2026
2H 2028	Lam Research	NAND wafer starts **about 20% below peak**; 2026–27 supply comes mostly from upgrading tools to 200+ layers, greenfield only **from around 2H 2028**. Citi TMT Sep 2026; CQ3-26 call

3 · Four openings the suppliers have given you themselves

1 · THEY HAVE SAID THE INCREASES MODERATE

Micron's CFO: fiscal 2027 margins expand on "continued price increases, **albeit at a more moderate pace**", adding "we have said for some time that eventually price increases would moderate".

Micron FQ4-26 call, 30 Sep 2026

Expect an increase, and argue about its size against the supplier's own word.

2 · THEY HAVE SAID THEIR PRICES ARE KILLING DEMAND

SK Hynix: PC and mobile shipments are expected to **fall** on higher memory prices. Samsung: smartphone volumes already fell, and 2027 unit volumes are expected to decline. TSMC: price-sensitive segments "are being challenged" by rising component prices.

Q3-26 calls, Oct 2026

The tight-supply account is not uniform by segment, and they said it first.

3 · DDR4 HAS SECOND SOURCES ADDING CAPACITY

Winbond's DRAM bits rose about **25% in one quarter** as 16nm ramps, and it describes the DDR4/LPDDR4 gap as evident through 2028. Nanya's bits stay flat only **until new fab output in 2H 2027**.

Winbond CQ1-CQ2-26 presentations; Nanya Q3-26 call, 12 Oct 2026

Where the part is DDR4-class, the single-source assumption is wrong.

4 · KIOXIA IS THE UNCOMMITTED DOOR

Only **50% of shipments targeted under agreement by 2028**, against Samsung already at 60–70% of capacity and Micron above 75% of FY27. Kioxia's gross margin is at a six-year high with capital spending at 12% of revenue, against its own 40% in fiscal 2022.

Kioxia Q1-26 call; filed accounts

Qualification, not availability, is the constraint here — so start it now.

4 · Three decisions, and the date each one is really due

Before FY27 commitments	**Prepay, or not.** Samsung requires advance payments, SK Hynix deposits — a capital decision, not a procurement one. **Price it against your own return on cash:** it pays only if the discount beats what that cash earns while it is held. Set the annual ceiling and the approver before a negotiation forces it.
Before signing a quantity	**Commit capacity, not quantity.** Suppliers say they are buying planning visibility. A reserved share of output with a quarterly draw inside an agreed band gives them that without you signing a number you cannot forecast. Untested: nothing public says any of them has written it that way.
Q1 2027, at the latest	**Open the second source while it is still open.** Kioxia for NAND, Winbond and Nanya for DDR4-class DRAM. Qualification takes longer than the window: Kioxia's agreement year is 2028, Nanya's new output 2H 2027.

5 · Two things not to plan on

The forecast you are probably using. TrendForce came in **20–40 points low in every quarter we can measure** — it raised 4Q26 DDR5 from +10–15% to about +20% on 20 October, after 3Q26 settled near +40%. Its August chart has 1Q27 at about +9%, levelling from mid-2027. The same lag is likely at the turn, which is when buyers will be locked into agreements priced off today's numbers.

The supplier's own outlook. Samsung expects it "unlikely to see any significant increase in incremental supply through 2028"; SK Hynix calls the constraint one "projected to continue through 2030". **These are forecasts by interested parties**, not filed facts — worth knowing, not a basis for accepting a term.

Sources: earnings calls, investor presentations and filed statements for the quarters named beside each line — Micron, SK Hynix, Samsung, Kioxia, Seagate, Nanya, Winbond, Lam Research, TSMC — plus TrendForce press releases for the forecast comparison. Evidence to 3 Nov 2026; every quote verified against its source before publication. **Nothing here is a price forecast or a prediction of shortage.** Semitrical · contact@semitrical.ai · built from public filings; first-pass analysis to support your own review, not legal, investment or professional advice.